

Case Preparation

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Motion Examples

- **Examples of Motions**
 - THBT the interests of the Chinese people would be better served by a peaceful transition into a democracy, rather than a continuation of the one party rule
 - In times of public health crisis, THBT governments should deny doctors the right to unionise
 - During times of ethno-religious conflicts, THS governments deploying the national military at religious places of worship that are likely to be affected by the conflict
 - THBT a second Donald Trump presidency is in the interests of the citizens of the United States of America
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STEP 1: Identifying the **impact**

- The goal is to figure out which impact needs to be **prioritised** - there can be a load of impacts
 - Fastest Conflict Resolution
 - Trust from the religious community
 - The least divisive resolution
 - Filter based on:
 - Impact **easiest** to achieve and weigh (certainty, logical priority, scale, intensity, etc)
 - Impact which has the largest **tipping point**.
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STEP 2: Assessing extent - **Tipping Point**

- Can the other team claim the same impact?
 - Not at all
 - They can, but not to the extent we can
 - They can, maybe as much as we can
 - Maybe more than us
- Situation 1
 - Assess whether this can weighed easily against impacts the opposing team can run.
- Situation 2
 - Probably the opposing team might run the same impact, so the goal is to win on extents from the start

STEP 3:

Contextualising the argument

- Contextualising:
 - The **regions** in which the argument/impact might be relevant
 - The specific **groups of people** who might be affected the most
 - The **time periods** in which the argument might be most relevant
- Don't contextualise:
 - Things not relevant to the argument/impact
 - Things that the opposing team is unlikely to contest

STEP 4: Discussing **Mechanisms**

- Pathways to reach the impact from your contextualisation
 - Must always be exclusive to the motion in question - it is very easy to think of non exclusive mechanisms
 - Without mechanisms - arguments/impacts would always sound implausible even though somewhat possible
 - Always compliment them with examples/appealing to intuitions
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STEP 5: Establishing the impacts' importance - **Weighing**

- There is no one definitive way to weigh - it could be anything that establishes the importance of your argument
 - Logical Priority
 - Certainty
 - Scale
 - Intensity
 - Resilience to getting responded
 - Always explain your weighing - not a useful exercise to stop at saying “our impact is most certain”. Explain why!
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Rebuttal

Response to a statement, argument, or claim made by an opposing speaker:

- A really assertive claim such as *“All Humans are Nihilistic”*
- A factually incorrect statement, such as *“Ronald Reagan is the current President of the US”*
- A well proven argument of why *pharmaceutical companies in India produce very bad medicines*

Importance of Rebuttal

- **Weakens the opposing team's case**
 - Illustrates why their material is either:
 - Untrue
 - Non-exclusive to their stance
 - Even if
 - Less relevant
 - Balances the debate and helps a team win
- **Enhances Critical Thinking and Persuasion**
 - An unengaging debate is boring
 - Impromptu rebuttal is the mark of a great debater